AFTERCARE

Caring for Your New Tattoo

For the first couple of weeks your tattoo is a healing wound. Clean, gentle, simple care helps it heal smoothly and keeps the lines and color at their best.

YOUR LOGO

WHEN	WHAT'S NORMAL	DO	AVOID
First day wrap on	Redness, tenderness and swelling. Clear plasma and a little ink seep out.	Wrap off after [2–5] hours. Wash with clean hands, lukewarm water and fragrance-free soap. Pat dry.	Re-wrapping in plastic, scrubbing, or sleeping on it. Alcohol tonight.
Days 2–3 settling	Oozing slows. It may feel warm and tight, and look shiny or slightly raised.	Wash [2–3] times a day. Let it air-dry, then add a very thin layer of ointment.	Thick ointment or petroleum jelly. Tight clothes rubbing the area.
Days 4–14 peeling	Flaking, peeling and itching. Colors can look cloudy or dull for a while.	Switch to fragrance-free lotion, thin layers, a few times a day. Loose, clean clothes.	Picking, scratching or slapping. Pools, baths, hot tubs, the sea and sun.
Weeks 2–4 healed surface	Skin looks healed but may stay shiny. Deeper healing goes on for weeks.	Keep moisturizing. Once fully healed, SPF 30+ every time it sees sun.	Tanning beds and sunburn. Any touch-up before [4–6] weeks.

GOOD TO KNOW

- Change your sheets and pillowcase tonight
- Fragrance-free products only until healed
- Colored flakes are normal, not lost ink
- Gym: wait [48] hours, wipe equipment first
- Short showers are fine; avoid a direct spray
- No antibiotic creams unless a doctor prescribes them
- Keep pets off the bed and away from it
- Healing takes longer on hands, feet and joints

Clean hands
Before every touch.

Thin layers
A little goes a long way.

Hands off
Let flakes fall off.

Shade it
No sun, then SPF for life.

CALL ME AND SEE A DOCTOR IF YOU NOTICE

- Redness or swelling spreading after day 3
- Yellow or green pus, or a bad smell
- Red streaks, heat or severe throbbing pain
- Fever, chills, a rash, hives or lasting bumps

Any of these: see your doctor, then text me so I can log the ink batch.

Swelling of the face or throat, or trouble breathing: call 911.

PLACEMENT & DATE _____

OINTMENT & LOTION TO USE _____

TOUCH-UP CHECK BY _____